

Copper Curls® Pekin Lilac

Syringa reticulata ssp. *pekinensis* 'SunDak' (Family: *Oleaceae*)

Description: A small tree with showy creamy white blossoms and very showy coppery-orange exfoliating bark. Grown either as a single or multi-trunked tree. Cold-tolerant and able to withstand urban environments (soil and pollution) make this an excellent tree for a variety of landscape uses.

Hardiness: USDA hardiness zones 3 to 7

Native Habitat: Northern China

Mature Size: Height: 25', Spread: 25'

Form (Shape): Rounded to upright spreading habit

Growth Rate: Moderate

Foliage: Deciduous. Summer foliage is a glossy dark green. Fall color varies from yellow to yellow-green, not showy.

Texture: Medium

Flowers: Creamy-white flower panicles in late spring/early summer, 12 -14 days after Common Lilac (*Syringa vulgaris*).

Fruit: Large tannish clusters of capsules remain on the tree, which add interest to the winter landscape.

Light: Full sun to part shade

Soil: Moist, well-drained soil is preferable. Plant is pH tolerant.

Propagation: Grafting, tissue culture or softwood cuttings

Failure Patterns: Tree failure is uncommon

Insects and Diseases: No serious insect or disease problems

Landscape Use: Copper Curls® Pekin Lilac is a late blooming small tree featuring showy plumes of fragrant creamy-white flowers. It has extremely showy exfoliating coppery-orange bark, which adds significant winter interest. One of the most trouble-free lilacs. Good choice for attracting butterflies and possibly deer resistant. This specimen is tolerant of urban conditions. It is recommended as a boulevard, small shade or landscape specimen tree.

Availability: Available in retail nurseries

Comments: Copper Curls® was introduced in collaboration with Dr. Scott Redlin, Raleigh, NC.